

Field CHA-025

61 acres in Champaign County, Illinois. What the satellite record shows for the 2026 season.

Prepared Oct 6, 2026
Imagery through Oct 2, 2026
Villicus



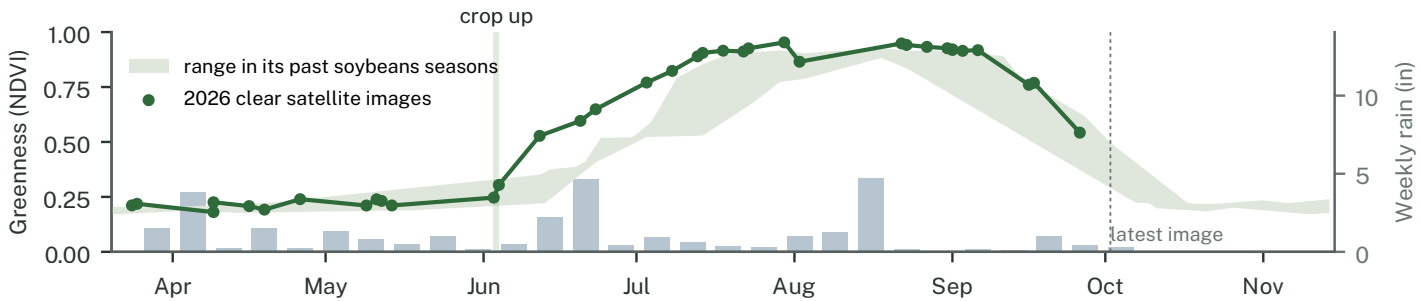
USDA NAIP aerial photo, 2023. Field boundary in yellow.

2026 crop	Soybeans (high confidence)
Crop came up	between Jun 3 and Jun 4, so likely planted May 20 to May 28
Harvest	crop still green in the last clear image (Sep 26)
After the 2025 harvest	Tilled (spring); residue dropped between May 9, 2026 and May 14, 2026
Winter 2025-26	Unclear: a little green in 5 winter images, below the cover-crop threshold
Season greenness	1st greenest of its 4 soybeans seasons since 2020; 86th percentile of 1,753 Champaign County soybeans fields

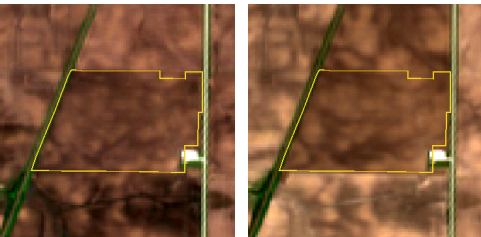
2019 Corn	2020 Soybeans	2021 Corn	2022 Soybeans	2023 Corn	2024 Soybeans	2025 Corn	2026 Soybeans
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Crop by year: USDA Cropland Data Layer 2019-2025; 2026 from our model.

The 2026 season

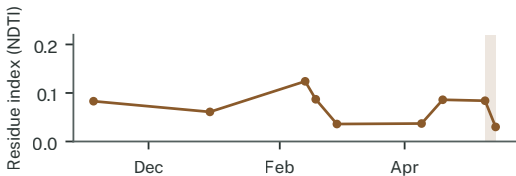


After the 2025 harvest



May 9, 2026, Sentinel-2 (before)

May 14, 2026, Sentinel-2 (after)



Worth a look

Nothing inside the boundary stood out in the last four seasons: no persistent low spots, no hot spots, no change in land use.

This field is in soybeans for 2026, and the crop was up by Jun 4. Harvest has not shown up in the imagery yet; the latest clear image is from Sep 26. Through the summer it stayed ahead of most soybeans fields in the county (86th percentile on greenness), which tracks crop vigor but is not a yield estimate. It was tilled after last year's harvest (between May 9, 2026 and May 14, 2026), and nothing inside the boundary stood out as a problem area.

Evidence. Dates above rest on these satellite scenes: May 9 2026, tillage (S2B T16TDK orbit 126); May 14 2026, tillage (S2C T16TDK orbit 126); Jun 3 2026, crop up (S2C T16TDK orbit 126); Jun 4 2026, crop up (Landsat 8 path/row 023032); Jul 30 2026, peak (Landsat 9 path/row 023032); Sep 26 2026, dry-down, harvest (S2B T16TDK orbit 126). The chart and winter checks use 78 clear images from Aug 2025 on, all listed in the field record file.

How it was made. Greenness is NDVI and the residue index is NDTI, averaged 10 m inside the boundary (USDA NASS Crop Sequence Boundaries). Crop up is when greenness first passed 0.30; planting is estimated 1-2 weeks earlier. Hot spots use Landsat 8/9 surface temperature. Season greenness tracks crop vigor and is not a yield estimate.